Knee arthroscopy is the most common arthroscopic procedure and is performed to diagnose and treat intra-articular disorders of the knee such as a torn meniscus and torn cruciate ligaments. Trocars are inserted into the knee joint—most commonly, in positions just lateral and just medial to the patellar ligament. Insertion points above, below, and even on the posterior aspect of the knee may also be used. The portals allow the insertion of an arthroscope and instruments for examination and treatment of the joint derangement.



The leg is placed in a thigh holder with the foot of the table lowered 90 degrees. Most surgeons utilize a thigh tourniquet. The duration of the procedure can be from 30 minutes for a simple arthroscopic examination to 3 hours or more for cruciate ligament repairs. Regional anesthesia or a combination of regional and general anesthesia are usually performed.

The most common complication of knee arthroscopy is hemarthrosis.

Jaffe RA, Schmiesing CA, Golianu B. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 5th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Wolters Kluwer Health, 2014: 1046-1047.

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